

ELI15 agent.md, prompt.md, skills.md

Here's the simple version, like you're 15 and building AI tools or coding assistants.

prompt.md

Think of this as:

"The instructions you give the AI."

It's usually a markdown file containing:

- *what the AI should do*
- *how it should behave*
- *rules*
- *tone*
- *examples*

Example:

Prompt

You are a helpful coding assistant.

Always explain code simply.

Never delete files unless asked.

So prompt.md = the AI's brain instructions.

agent.md

This is usually:

"The identity + responsibilities of an AI agent."

An "agent" is an AI that can:

- *think through tasks*
- *use tools*
- *read files*
- *make decisions*
- *sometimes take actions automatically*

agent.md often defines:

- *the agent's role*
- *goals*
- *workflow*
- *permissions*
- *tool usage*

Example:

Agent: Bug Fixer

Goal:

Fix frontend bugs safely.

Rules:

- *Run tests before editing*
- *Never modify backend files*
- *Ask before deleting code*

So agent.md = the AI worker's job description.

skills.md

This is:

"What the AI knows how to do."

It lists capabilities, tools, or specialties.

Example:

Skills

- *React debugging*
- *TypeScript refactoring*
- *Writing unit tests*
- *API integration*

Sometimes each skill includes:

- *instructions*
- *workflows*

- *examples*
- *best practices*

So skills.md = the AI's skill tree / abilities list.

Easy Analogy

Imagine building a game character:

<i>File</i>	<i>Meaning</i>
<i>prompt.md</i>	<i>Personality + rules</i>
<i>agent.md</i>	<i>Mission/job</i>
<i>skills.md</i>	<i>Powers/abilities</i>

In Modern AI Coding Systems

These files are common in:

- *AI coding assistants*
- *autonomous agents*
- *Cursor-style workflows*
- *OpenAI agent systems*
- *Claude Code setups*
- *Devin-like systems*

They help organize AI behavior cleanly instead of stuffing everything into one giant prompt.

How They Work Together

Example:

agent.md
↓
defines role

prompt.md

↓

defines behavior

skills.md

↓

defines capabilities

Together they create a more reliable AI assistant.

Tiny Real-World Example

You want an AI “YouTube Script Writer”.

agent.md

You are a YouTube scriptwriting agent.

Your goal is to create engaging 8-minute scripts.

prompt.md

Use simple language.

Add hooks every 30 seconds.

Keep tone energetic.

skills.md

- Storytelling

- Hook writing

- Retention optimization

- SEO titles

Now the AI behaves consistently.

Short Version

- *prompt.md → “How should the AI behave?”*
- *agent.md → “What is the AI’s job?”*
- *skills.md → “What can the AI do?”*

ELI 5 same md files

Imagine you have a robot helper 🤖

You give it:

- a job
- some rules
- and teach it skills

These files are just little note papers for the robot.

prompt.md

This is the robot's rules paper.

It says things like:

- “Be nice”
- “Explain simply”
- “Do homework carefully”

Example:

Be friendly.

Use easy words.

Help with math.

So:

prompt.md = “How should the robot talk and act?”

agent.md

This is the robot's job paper.

It says:

- *what the robot does*
- *what its mission is*

Example:

You are a homework helper robot.

Help kids solve problems.

So:

agent.md = “What is the robot’s job?”

skills.md

This is the robot’s things it knows paper.

Example:

- *counting*
- *spelling*
- *drawing*

So:

skills.md = “What can the robot do?”

Super Simple Version

<i>File</i>	<i>Like</i>
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<i>prompt.md</i>	<i>Rules</i>
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<i>agent.md</i>	<i>Job</i>
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<i>skills.md</i>	<i>Skills</i>
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Tiny Example

A pizza robot 🍕

agent.md

You make pizza.

prompt.md

Be polite.

Make pizza fast.

skills.md

- *dough making*
- *cheese adding*
- *baking*

Why ELI makes learning easier?

“ELI” means:

Explain Like I’m...

Examples:

- *ELI5 → Explain Like I’m 5 years old*
- *ELI15 → Explain Like I’m 15*

It’s a way of asking for:

- *simpler words*
 - *easy examples*
 - *less jargon*
 - *relatable analogies*
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Why It Makes Learning Easier

Normally, people explain things like this:

A neural network is a computational architecture using weighted parameters for pattern recognition.

ELI5 version:

It’s like teaching a robot by showing it lots of examples.

Same idea.

Way easier to understand.

Example:

<i>Hard</i>	<i>ELI</i>
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<i>CPU scheduler</i>	<i>traffic police for programs</i>
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<i>Database index</i>	<i>book index</i>
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<i>API</i>	<i>waiter taking orders</i>
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Your brain learns faster when it can compare new things to familiar things.